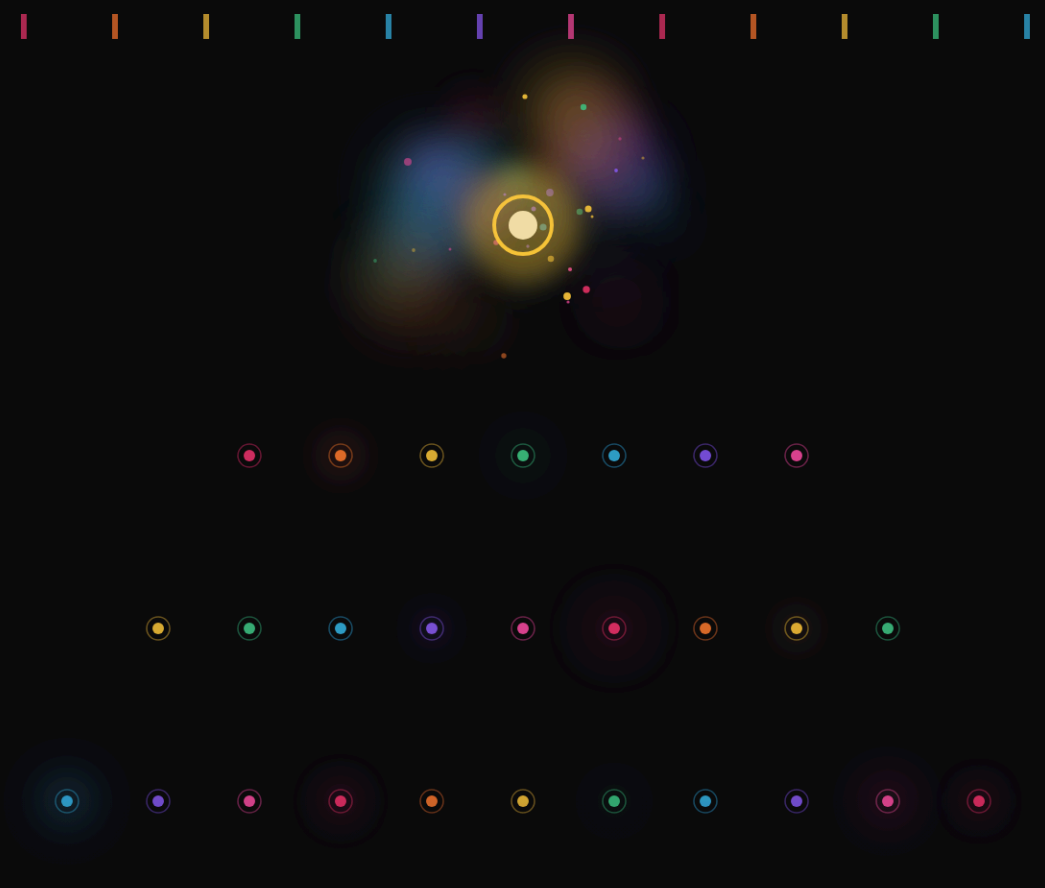


FOR EDUCATORS · THE ARTIST OPERATOR BY JAMIL APOSTOL



TEACHING THE ARTIST OPERATOR

A twelve-week curriculum for music schools,
conservatories & artist development programs.

ABOUT THIS COURSE

The gap this course fills: music programs teach the craft superbly and the career barely at all. Graduates leave with technique and no operation — no pipeline, no list, no money system, no framework for the AI tools already reorganizing their industry. **Teaching the Artist Operator** is a twelve-week, portfolio-based course built on the book **THE ARTIST OPERATOR** and its companion workbooks, designed to be taught by one instructor to 12–30 students, in person or remote.

The pedagogy is operational, not theoretical. Students do not write papers about the music business; they leave week twelve with a running operation: a scored audit of their own career, a live email list, a real booking pipeline with pitches sent, a twelve-month money map, a moat inventory, and a manifesto. The final assessment is the operation itself, presented.

What the instructor needs: the book (one copy per student), the Playbook workbook (the write-in companion), and the companion packs used in weeks 3, 6, and 8 — available under education licensing with bulk pricing. No specialized software beyond a spreadsheet and any mainstream email platform; AI tool access (free tiers suffice) for weeks 4–5.

Outcomes. On completion, students can: diagnose a career across the Six Jobs from evidence; operate a booking pipeline end to end; run lumpy income through a four-account split; deploy AI leverage inside explicit human limits; and articulate, in writing, what in their work is never for sale or delegation.

“Students do not study the operation. They build one, and present it.”

TEACHING THE ARTIST OPERATOR

WEEKS 1–6

01 THE ARTIST IS CHANGING Book Part I (Ch. 1–2)

Why the traditional artist career died, and what replaced it. The operator mindset: default is also a design.

In class: each student maps their current 'operation' as it actually exists — every task, tool, and dependency on one page. It will be chaos. That page is the before photo.

Assignment: read Part I; write one page on the moment the industry's change became personal.

02 THE MARKET GAP Book Part I (Ch. 3–5)

Every pipe was built for the delivery side; the artist's side got an envelope. Platforms, leverage, and who owns the connection.

In class: trace one real artist's revenue through the middle layers — who touched the dollar, who kept what, who owned the fan relationship at the end.

Assignment: inventory your own dependencies — every platform that stands between you and the people who care about your work.

03 THE SIX JOBS Book Part II (Ch. 6–10)

CREATE, BUILD, DISTRIBUTE, CONNECT, MONETIZE, SERVE — every career runs all six, on purpose or by neglect.

In class: run the full Six Jobs Audit (companion pack). Score from evidence, not mood. Pair students to challenge each other's scores.

Assignment: complete the audit; identify your lowest-scoring job and write the honest paragraph about why it is the lowest. ASSESSMENT 1 — the audit (15%).

04 THE AI TEAM: FIRST HIRES Book Part III (Ch. 11–13)

The AI Leverage Ladder, rungs one through three: from asking questions to delegating whole workflows.

In class: live build — each student sets up one working AI workflow for a real task from their audit (bio rewrite, pitch email drafts, setlist logistics).

Assignment: run the workflow for a week; log what it saved and where it failed. Bring the log.

05 WHAT STAYS HUMAN Book Part III (Ch. 14–15)

The four never-automate rules: taste, relationships, presence, the core of the art. Where delegation stops.

In class: debate — students argue for and against automating specific real tasks; the class drafts its own never-automate lines.

Assignment: write your four rules as sentences you could repeat to a bandmate; collect one example where automation crossed a line for an artist you follow.

06 THE ARTIST AS CEO Book Part IV (Ch. 16–18)

The Not-Doing List, the calendar as strategy, and the direct line — the one channel no platform can repossess.

In class: every student starts a real email list (tool, signup page, welcome email) before the session ends. Not a plan for one. One.

Assignment: the 30-day Direct Line sprint begins (companion pack), weeks 1–2: the foundation and the first fifty names.

WEEKS 7–12

07 BOOKING AS A PIPELINE Book Part IV (Ch. 19–21)

Shows as sales: prospect, pitch, hold, confirm, settle. Deal memos, advancing, day sheets, settlement discipline.

In class: workshop real pitch emails to real venues; role-play the follow-up and the settlement conversation.

Assignment: build your booking pipeline with ten real prospects; send at least three pitches. ASSESSMENT 2 — pipeline + pitch portfolio (20%).

08 THE MONEY YEAR Book Part V (Ch. 22–26)

Lumpy income, the four-account split, the fixed salary, merch unit economics, and multiple revenue streams.

In class: run the Money Year map and the merch break-even math with real or realistic numbers (companion spreadsheet).

Assignment: complete your twelve-month money map with the split set and salary chosen. ASSESSMENT 3 — the money map (20%).

09 THE HUMAN BEHIND THE ARTIST Book Part VI (Ch. 27–30)

Persona and person, inputs and composting, what the work is offered to. The chapters the rest of the book protects.

In class: quiet session — the reflection pages from the Playbook, written by hand, not shared unless volunteered.

Assignment: one deliberate input per week for the rest of the course (a show, a book, a place, a conversation); keep the ledger.

10 THE MOAT Book Part VII (Ch. 31–33)

When every artist has an AI team, the scarce inputs are the ones that cannot be downloaded: the ten moat items.

In class: the evidence inventory — ten moat items, one piece of concrete evidence each from the last twelve months. Blanks are data.

Assignment: design experience deposits for your two weakest moat items — rooms, roads, people, things to live through.

11 THE MANIFESTO Book Part VII (Ch. 34–35)

The whole argument lands: what you refuse, what you build, whom it serves, what stays human.

In class: manifesto workshop — short lines, strong verbs, read aloud. Peer edit for the sentence that isn't true yet.

Assignment: finish the manifesto and assemble the final portfolio: audit, pipeline, money map, moat inventory, manifesto.

12 THE OPERATION, PRESENTED Full portfolio

Each student presents their operation as it now exists — the after photo against week one's before photo.

In class: 10-minute presentations: what changed, what the numbers say, what runs without them, what stays human. Invited industry guests strongly recommended.

ASSESSMENT 4 — final portfolio and presentation (35%). Participation across the term: 10%.

ASSESSMENT & LICENSING

Assessment is the portfolio, weighted toward doing:

15% **THE SIX JOBS AUDIT** Week 3 — scored from evidence, graded on honesty and specificity, not on the scores themselves.

20% **PIPELINE + PITCH PORTFOLIO** Week 7 — ten real prospects, three sent pitches, the deal memo drafted.

20% **THE MONEY MAP** Week 8 — twelve months mapped, split set, salary chosen, fat and lean months named.

35% **FINAL PORTFOLIO + PRESENTATION** Week 12 — the whole operation: before photo, after photo, numbers, manifesto.

10% **PARTICIPATION** Showing up is the job. The course grades what careers grade.

Formats. The twelve weeks compress cleanly to an 8-week intensive (merge weeks 4–5 and 10–11) or expand to a full semester (add a second presentation round and a guest-practitioner series). It also runs as a five-day workshop for artist development programs, one part per day, portfolio abbreviated.

Licensing & bulk materials. Institutional licensing includes instructor materials, the right to reproduce the worksheet packs for enrolled students, and bulk pricing on books and Playbook workbooks (40–55% off list). Site licenses run per program, per year. Author guest sessions — remote or in person — and instructor onboarding are available with the license.

Contact: education@headline.world · headline.world

GO FURTHER

This curriculum teaches **THE ARTIST OPERATOR: How Musicians Win in the Age of AI, and Why the Future Still Belongs to Humans** by Jamil Apostol as it was meant to be used: not read, run. The author spent a decade as a touring independent artist across nine countries and now builds **Headline.world**, the operating system for independent musicians that grew out of the same problems this course teaches students to solve.

Companion materials used in the course: **The Artist Operator Playbook** (the write-in workbook), **The Six Jobs Audit**, **Direct Line**, **The Artist's Money Year**, **Merch Math**, and **The Artist's Contract Vault**. All are available under education licensing.



HEADLINE.WORLD

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